

Forgotten

They pledged their lives to their country for the duration of WWII.

They marched to the drumming of heartbeats; theirs and those entrusted to their care.

No bugler sounded reveille, yet they rose at dawn and donned their uniforms

Then reported to their battle stations; hospitals in every corner of America.

Their enemies: Infantile paralysis, Tuberculosis, infectious diseases and injuries.

Their weapons: skills, pills, and stamina.

Without them, our nation's healthcare system would have collapsed resulting in a demoralized and ailing population.

Without them, there would have been a continued shortage of nurses for our armed services; more fatalities; perhaps a longer war.

They were the 180,000 young women of the United States Cadet Nurse Corps: women of all races and ethnicities.

They helped win World War II!

Yet, no flags adorn their graves, for these veterans of the *Corps* remain unacknowledged by our Government and unknown by most Americans today.